

FREE PORT GUIDE · PORT OF CALL

Kralendijk, Bonaire
Your Margaritaville at Sea day ashore

A diver's paradise: the whole coastline is a protected marine park, flamingos wade in pink salt flats, and a sleepy, colorful little capital sits right at the pier.

SHIPS THAT CALL HERE
Beachcomber on select Southern Caribbean sailings (2027 and later)

WHERE YOU DOCK
Kralendijk's cruise pier, right in the middle of town

WALK TO TOWN
Steps away: the waterfront, shops and cafés start at the pier

MONEY
The U.S. dollar is Bonaire's official currency

ISLAND TIME
Atlantic time, no daylight saving. Always go by ship time

ID AND LANGUAGE
Bring your passport. Locals speak Papiamentu and Dutch, and English is widely spoken

🛳️ Stepping off the ship

At the pier

- You step off **right onto Kralendijk's waterfront**, with no shuttle needed. The town is small, walkable and relaxed.
- Water taxis to Klein Bonaire leave from the waterfront, a short walk away.
- **Booked a tour?** Check your voucher for the meeting spot near the pier.

Getting around

- **Taxis** wait near the pier. There are no meters, so **agree on the fare first**. Rates are set per car.
- Bonaire is spread out and has no real bus system, so for flamingos, salt flats or Lac Bay, take a **tour or taxi**.
- Bikes, scooters and golf carts can be rented in town. Watch for donkeys and goats on the road!

🐠 **Snorkeling or diving?** Bonaire requires a **nature fee** for anyone going in the marine park's waters, sold online at stinapa.bonairenaturefee.org. Many tours handle it for you, so ask when you book.

🌴 Pick your perfect Bonaire day

🤿 Klein Bonaire snorkel

15 min by water taxi

The little uninhabited island across the bay is ringed by healthy reef and gin-clear water. No Name Beach is a favorite: bring water and shade, because there are no facilities. Grab a water taxi or a snorkel boat from the waterfront.

🦩 Flamingos and salt flats

Half day by tour or taxi

Head south to see flamingos feeding in the pink salt ponds, gleaming white salt pyramids, and the tiny historic slave huts, a sobering, important stop. It's one of the most photogenic drives in the Caribbean.

🐟 Shore snorkeling

Minutes from town

On Bonaire you can walk right off the beach onto the reef. Famous spots like 1000 Steps (really about 70) are a short ride north. Use water shoes, and enter only where you see a sandy or marked path.

🏄 Lac Bay and mangroves

About 25 min by taxi

The east side's shallow, wind-swept bay is a windsurfing hotspot with a laid-back beach bar at Sorobon. Guided kayak tours glide through mangroves full of baby fish and birds.

🫏 Donkey Sanctuary

About 15 min by taxi

A drive-through rescue home for hundreds of friendly donkeys (and a few other animals). Kids love it, and the entry fee supports the sanctuary.

🛍️ Kralendijk stroll

Walk from the pier

Browse the colorful shops and art galleries, sip a coffee or cold drink on the waterfront, and watch divers come and go. It's an easy, relaxing way to spend the day.

🍽️ Local flavors to try

- **Fresh-caught fish** such as wahoo, mahi or snapper, grilled with local sides.
- **Kabritu stoba:** a hearty island goat stew.
- **Pastechi:** stuffed pastries, perfect for the walk back to the ship.
- **Dutch snacks** like bitterballen and stroopwafels.
- **A cold Polar or Amstel Bright** at a waterfront bar. 🍺
- **Tap water is safe** here. It's made from seawater, so refill your bottle.

💵 Money, shopping and tipping

- **U.S. dollars are the local currency,** so there's no exchange needed. Cards are widely accepted.
- Bring small bills for water taxis, taxis and tips.
- Check for a service charge on restaurant bills; tip about 10–15% if none is added.
- Popular take-homes: Bonaire sea salt, local art, and anything with a flamingo on it. 🦩

☀️ Weather and staying safe

Bonaire is dry, sunny and breezy all year, with highs in the upper 80s °F. It sits south of the usual hurricane path, and rain comes mostly in short showers late in the year.

👉 **Check the forecast before you go:** Kralendijk 10-day forecast on weather.com (or scan the code).

Protect the reef (and yourself)

- Use **reef-safe, mineral sunscreen**, and a rash guard is even better.
- **Don't touch, stand on or kick the coral.** Bonaire takes reef protection seriously.
- Wear water shoes: shore entries can be rocky and sharp.

Smart cruiser habits

- Agree on taxi fares **before** you get in, and set a pickup time for the return.
- Don't leave bags unattended at snorkel spots or in parked cars.
- The sun and wind are strong, so drink plenty of water.
- Bring your passport ashore, or a copy if your ship advises keeping it on board.

🎒 Your Bonaire day bag

- ☐ Ship card (room key) and passport
- ☐ Small U.S. bills for taxis and tips
- ☐ Nature fee receipt, if you're snorkeling on your own
- ☐ Reef-safe sunscreen, hat and sunglasses
- ☐ Swimsuit, rash guard and water shoes
- ☐ Snorkel mask (optional)
- ☐ Refillable water bottle
- ☐ Phone set to **ship time**, with an alarm
- ☐ Ship's port agent number from your Cruise News
- ☐ Waterproof phone pouch

Want the best of Bonaire without the guesswork?

Our travel advisors can line up snorkel trips, flamingo tours and kayak adventures that fit your ship's time in port.

📲 **Scan the code** to browse and book Bonaire shore excursions.

Questions? **admin@thechillcompass.com**

Information current as of October 2026, gathered from Bonaire's park authority (STINAPA), tourism sources and cruise travel sources. Piers, times, prices and fees change, so please confirm with your ship's daily Cruise News before heading out. Travel times are approximate. Excursions are booked through Shore Excursions Group, and we may earn a commission at no extra cost to you. The Chill Compass is an independent blog and is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by Margaritaville at Sea or Margaritaville Enterprises. All trademarks belong to their respective owners. Presented by Cruises Tours and Travel, LLC · Florida Seller of Travel Reg. No. ST150140.